

Site Inspection App — Setup & User Guide

Offline field inspection app for iPad, iPhone, Android and PC

App v1.4 · Form 4.2 · Project 2.1 — Site Assessment Live app: <https://ds-js1.github.io/dryspace-inspect/>

What changed in v1.4. The record itself now moves through SharePoint — handed over and picked up through the inspection's own folder, with no file to email. Work in progress is backed up automatically. The buttons moved to the top of the form. Parts A and D changed most.

Part A — What has been built

An offline-first web app built from the v4 Site Inspection Form: 13 sections, 154 labelled fields, roughly 400 data points, with every dynamic reveal preserved.

Key behaviours

- **Continuous autosave** — every keystroke, tick and photo saved within half a second. A "Saved [time]" indicator confirms it. No Save button, and nothing to lose if the battery dies.
- **Works with no signal at all.** Everything is stored on the device.
- **Suspend and resume** — leave an inspection at any point and reopen it later. Multiple inspections can be open at once.
- **Edit after completion** — an inspection marked Complete can still be reopened, edited and re-sent.
- **Stage tracking** — every inspection shows who holds it, who last edited it and when. Stage changes are logged to an audit trail that travels with the record.
- **Measurement schedule** — Section 07 holds a table of wall faces with length, height, calculated area, treatment and grade, with running totals.
- **Office pre-fill and handover** — the office fills Section 01 during the qualification call, then shares a draft to the field team.
- **Photos upload to SharePoint** (*new in v1.3*) — full-quality originals, filed automatically into the inspection's own folder.
- **Send** — one button builds a self-contained HTML report (all answers, embedded photos, the Dryspace logo) and opens the device share sheet.
- **Data backup** — one tap on the home screen backs up all inspections as JSON.
- **The record travels through SharePoint** (*new in v1.4*) — handed over and picked up through the inspection's own folder, with no file to email.
- **Work in progress is backed up automatically** (*new in v1.4*) — so a lost phone no longer means a lost day.

What changed in v1.4

The record now moves through SharePoint, not the share sheet. Tap **Hand over through SharePoint** and the app uploads the inspection to its current/ folder and files the previous version in archive/. On a phone this simply was not possible before — the share sheet offered WhatsApp and Mail and no way to reach SharePoint at all.

You can pick an inspection up as well as put it down. Take over an inspection from SharePoint on the home screen lists everything waiting and brings the one you choose onto your device. Nobody has to send you a file.

Your work is backed up while you type. Every few minutes, and when you leave the form, the app quietly saves a copy to the inspection's `wip/` folder. If your phone is lost or broken, **Recover work in progress** on the home screen brings it back. Previously an unfinished inspection existed only on your device.

A backup in `wip/` is a **working copy, not the baton**. The live record is always the file in `current/`. The app keeps them apart on purpose.

The app will not let two people overwrite each other. If somebody else has handed the same inspection over since you picked it up, the app says who and when and asks before continuing. Their version is archived, never deleted.

The buttons moved to the top of the form. They used to sit below every section, so handing over meant scrolling past the whole form to reach them.

Both offline paths still exist, labelled *offline fallback: Share draft* and *Import from a file*. Use them when you have no signal — and remember that the filing into `current/` and `archive/` is then yours to do by hand.

Photo upload failures now tell you what went wrong. Each file shows its own state, its progress while uploading, and the actual reason if it fails. An upload that stalls now gives up and says so instead of sitting on "Uploading..." for ever.

What changed in v1.3

Photos now upload to SharePoint by themselves. Previously the full-quality originals existed only on the device, and were lost the moment it was wiped or the inspection deleted. This is the largest change and the reason for the rest.

You sign in once. Home screen → *Sign in*, using your Dryspace Microsoft account. It is remembered. Losing signal does not sign you out.

Nothing is deleted on trust. The app reads every uploaded file back out of SharePoint and confirms it arrived complete before treating it as done.

The app tells you when it has been updated. A green bar appears saying a new version is ready, with an *Update* button, plus a *Check for app update* button on the home screen. Updates no longer apply silently.

One folder per inspection in the new Site Inspections site, holding `current/`, `archive/` and `photos/` together. See `03_Handover` and `Version Control Protocol`.

Files say whose job they are. Photos and drafts now carry the client name, so a file that has been downloaded or emailed is still identifiable.

Part B — Deployment

Already done. Recorded for reference.

- **GitHub account:** DS-JS1 — a Dryspace business asset. Keep the login in the password manager.
- **Repository:** `github.com/DS-JS1/dryspace-inspect` — public. It holds only the blank form; no client or inspection data is ever committed to it.
- **Live address:** `https://ds-js1.github.io/dryspace-inspect/` — HTTPS via GitHub Pages from the `main` branch.

- **Publishing a new version** is covered in [02_Iteration Guide](#).

One-time setup for v1.3

Two things must be in place before photo upload will work:

1. **Entra app registration** with admin consent granted — the app cannot upload until a tenant administrator approves it once.
2. **The Site Inspections site**, its permission group, and the six index columns — see [03_Handover](#) and [Version Control Protocol §8](#).

Part C — Installing on each device

iPad / iPhone (Safari)

1. Open the live address **in Safari** — it must be Safari, not Chrome, for install to work on iOS.
2. Share icon → **Add to Home Screen** → Add.
3. Open it once from the home-screen icon while still online.

Android (Chrome)

1. Open the same address in Chrome.
2. ■ menu → **Add to Home screen** (or *Install app*).

Windows PC (Chrome or Edge) — for office pre-fill

1. Open the same address.
2. Click the install icon at the right of the address bar.

Always use the installed icon, not a browser tab. Installed apps get protected storage; data in an ordinary tab can be cleared by the browser.

Picking up a new version

From v1.3 the app tells you: a green bar appears saying a new version is ready. Tap **Update**. You can also check on demand with *Check for app update*.

The v1.3 update itself is the exception. Devices currently running v1.1.1 have no banner and cannot be given one retrospectively. For that one update, open the app while online, **fully close it (swipe it away)**, then open it again.

Part D — Using the app

Set your name once

At the top of any inspection there is a *Your name* box. Fill it in once and the app remembers it on that device. Your name is stamped into exported filenames and the audit trail.

Sign in once — new in v1.3

Home screen → **Sign in**, with your Dryspace Microsoft account. This is what lets photos upload. It is remembered, and losing signal does not sign you out.

Office workflow (qualification call)

1. On the office PC, tap **+ New inspection**. Set the stage to *01 Office* and fill Section 01 — HubSpot deal name, client, property, both contacts.
2. Paste the property listing URL if there is one, and upload any floor plans in Section 11. **This is the stage to do it** — there is signal at a desk.
3. Change the stage to *02 Field*, then tap **Hand over through SharePoint** at the top of the form. The app files it into `current/` and archives the previous version for you.
4. Tell the field inspector, with a link to the folder — not the file. Then delete your copy once they confirm they have it. See `03_Handover` and `Version Control Protocol`.

Field workflow (site visit)

1. Tap **Take over an inspection from SharePoint** and pick the job, or **+ New inspection** for a walk-in.
2. Work through Sections 02 to 06 plus 03A. Blank fields are fine.
3. **Do not skip Section 03A**. Asbestos likelihood, hazards, access constraints and the discharge point all affect safety and price.
4. Photograph in the **Camera app**, then attach — see Part E.
5. Watch for "Saved [time]" in the top bar.
6. To pause, just leave. Resume from the list any time.
7. When finished, set the stage to *03 Technical* and tap ****Hand over through SharePoint** — after checking the photos have uploaded.** The home screen card for each inspection says whether its files are waiting, all uploaded, or need attention.

Seeing what is still empty

Every field label carries a reference number such as `03.4`, which also shows whether the field has content:

- **Green with a tick** — this field has something in it. For photo blocks, at least one photo is attached.
- **Grey** — nothing entered. Often perfectly correct, which is why grey is quiet.
- **Amber** — only when *Highlight gaps* is switched on. Use it when reviewing before handing over.

Each section header shows a count, for example `12/19`. Because sections start collapsed, this is the fastest way to see where the gaps are.

Blank is not the same as wrong. The form is deliberately broader than any single job, so a lot of grey is normal. The counts exist to find genuine gaps, not to be driven to 100%.

Technical workflow — the measurement schedule

Section 07 holds one row per wall face or floor area to be treated:

1. Tap **+ Add wall face / area**.
2. Enter the face name (e.g. "East wall"), length and height in metres. The area calculates itself.
3. Choose the treatment and waterproofing grade, and note anything unusual — "behind stairs", "obstructed by services".

Totals for linear metres and square metres appear at the foot and carry into the report.

Why this matters. Before v1.2 this was a paragraph of prose that pricing had to interpret. This is the number the quote is built from.

Part E — Photos, video and files

Take photos in the Camera app — not in the form

Photograph what you need using the **Camera app**, then attach them to the right field. Two reasons, both worth knowing:

- Your camera roll keeps an **independent second copy**, before the app has it and after.
- Photos taken through a browser carry **no location detail**; ones from the Camera app do.

What the app keeps

Copy	Size	Purpose
Thumbnail	240 px	Previews in the form
Report copy	1,600 px, JPEG q0.72	Embedded in the emailed report
Original	Untouched	Uploaded to SharePoint as evidence

Documents, PDFs and video are stored exactly as supplied.

A typical 12-megapixel phone photo drops from roughly 4 MB to around 250 KB for the report copy — which is what keeps emailed reports deliverable.

Uploading

Back in signal — car, office, wifi — tap **Upload now** on the home screen. Each file is listed with its own state and, if one fails, the reason. It tells you how many files are waiting.

Wait until it says "**All photos uploaded**". Until then, those photos exist only on your device.

If something fails: "*No connection*" is normal in a basement. "*Need attention*" means tap **Try again**, and tell the office if it repeats — **before deleting anything**. A failed upload leaves the original untouched.

HEIC conversion — the honest position

- **On iPhone and iPad — works.** iOS converts HEIC to JPEG at the moment you pick the file.
- **On Windows — does not convert.** The browser cannot decode HEIC, so the file is stored untouched. Convert to JPEG before attaching if you are working on a PC.

In practice photos are taken on the iPad, so this rarely bites.

Video

Short clips up to about 30 seconds can go into the app alongside photos. Anything longer is recorded with the Camera app and uploaded to the inspection's folder via the **OneDrive app** — video does not upload through the inspection app.

Set this on every field device before it goes out:

- Settings → Camera → Record Video → **1080p HD at 30 fps**
- Settings → Camera → Formats → **High Efficiency**

Roughly 60 MB per minute instead of around 400 MB at 4K, with no loss of useful detail at review size.

Why video is not compressed in the app. Compressing video inside a browser on an iPad means shipping a 25–30 MB library and a process that fails unpredictably. The camera setting does the same job reliably, for free.

Protecting your data

- Each device holds its own inspections. Sending the report, sharing a draft or uploading photos is what turns it into shared business data.
- ****Only delete an inspection after its report has been sent and its photos show as uploaded.**** Delete is permanent and includes the photos.
- Use **Download data backup** weekly and file it in SharePoint. It covers field data across every inspection on that device — but **not** photos, which are covered by the SharePoint upload.
- Follow `03_Handover` and `Version Control Protocol` for anything passing between people.

Part F — Automatic filing of reports (Power Automate)

Optional. Roughly fifteen minutes, one time, using standard M365 connectors with no premium licence.

Photos no longer need this — they upload directly from v1.3. This flow is now only for filing the emailed report file.

1. Go to `make.powerautomate.com` signed in with your Dryspace M365 account. Create → Automated cloud flow, named "DS Inspection Reports".
2. In the trigger, open **Show advanced options**: Include Attachments = Yes, Only with Attachments = Yes, Subject Filter = `DS_Report`.
3. Add **Apply to each** → select *Attachments* from the trigger output.
4. Inside it, add the SharePoint action **Create file**: your site address, the target library folder, File Name and File Content from the attachment.
5. Save, then test by emailing yourself a report from the app.

Part G — Known limits of v1.4

- **No live cross-device sync** — by design, for offline reliability. Handing over through `current/` is the transfer mechanism; it moves when you tap the button, not continuously.
- **The automatic backup is a safety net, not a sync.** It writes your work to `wip/` while you edit. It does not merge, and it does not tell another device anything. Two people editing one inspection still produces two versions — the app will warn at handover, but it cannot combine them.
- **Nothing is deleted from SharePoint by the app**, ever. Old `wip/` files stay until somebody clears them out, and the device copy is yours to delete after a handover.
- **Report photos are compressed** to around 1,600 px to keep emails deliverable. The full-quality originals are in SharePoint.
- **Video never travels inside drafts or reports** — it goes via OneDrive.

- **Backups contain field data only** — no photos or video.
- **Reports produced by v1.0** (before 20 July 2026) cannot be re-imported. Reports from v1.1 onward can.
- **Print works best from the emailed report file** rather than inside the installed app — an iOS limitation.
- **The app address is publicly reachable** — standard for GitHub Pages on the free plan. It exposes only the blank form; every answer and photo lives in your tenant.
- **Photo upload needs admin consent**, granted once by a tenant administrator.
- **The Dryspace Guide still shows the 2009 grades.** The form moved to the BS8102:2022 classification in v1.2.1, so the Guide is now the document that disagrees.